

## Input Image

|                                                         | Surgical group<br>(n = 222) |         | Nonsurgical group<br>(n = 72) |         |         |
|---------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|---------|-------------------------------|---------|---------|
| Age (range)                                             | 43 (25-64)                  |         | 44 (26-63)                    |         | NS      |
| Mean pain duration, years (range)                       | 7.8 (2-34)                  |         | 8.5 (2-40)                    |         |         |
| Mean time of sick leave, years (range)                  | 3.2 (0.1-18)                |         | 2.9 (0.1-8)                   |         |         |
|                                                         | %                           | Missing | %                             | Missing | P value |
| Men                                                     | 49.5                        |         | 48.6                          |         | NS      |
| Married/living together                                 | 77.3                        | 2       | 76.4                          |         | NS      |
| Comorbidity                                             | 39.1                        | 7       | 23.5                          | 4       | 0.020   |
| Smoking                                                 | 40.6                        | 3       | 49.3                          | 1       | NS      |
| Earlier (>2 years) successful removal of herniated disc | 18.6                        | 2       | 19.4                          |         | NS      |
| Employed                                                | 72.8                        | 1       | 66.7                          |         | NS      |
| Changed work because of back problems                   | 29.4                        | 4       | 35.2                          | 1       | NS      |
| On sick leave because of back problems                  | 58.8                        |         | 54.2                          |         | NS      |
| Disability pension because of back problems             | 20.3                        |         | 22.2                          |         | NS      |
| Working part or full time                               | 20.9                        |         | 23.6                          |         | NS      |
| Litigation or compensation because of back problems     | 60.4                        |         | 64.6                          |         | NS      |
| Patient consider problems as back work injury           | 54.3                        | 12      | 64.2                          | 5       | NS      |

## GLM-OCR Output

|                                                         | Surgical group (n = 222) |         |      | Non-surgical group (n = 72) |   |         |
|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|---------|------|-----------------------------|---|---------|
|                                                         | %                        | Missing | %    | Missing                     | % | P value |
| Age (range)                                             | 43 (25-64)               |         |      | 44 (26-63)                  |   |         |
| Mean pain duration, years (range)                       | 7.8 (3-34)               |         |      | 8.5 (2-40)                  |   |         |
| Mean time of sick leave, years (range)                  | 2.2 (0.1-18)             |         |      | 2.9 (0.1-4)                 |   |         |
|                                                         | %                        | Missing | %    | %                           | % | P value |
| Men                                                     | 49.5                     |         | 48.6 |                             |   | NS      |
| Married/living together                                 | 77.3                     | 2       | 76.4 |                             |   | NS      |
| Comorbidity                                             | 39.1                     | 7       | 23.5 | 4                           |   | 0.020   |
| Smoking                                                 | 38.6                     | 3       | 40.9 | 1                           |   | NS      |
| Earlier (<2 years) successful removal of herniated disc | 18.6                     | 2       | 19.4 |                             |   | NS      |
| Employment                                              | 72.8                     | 1       | 68.7 |                             |   | NS      |
| Changed work because of back problems                   | 29.4                     | 4       | 35.2 | 1                           |   | NS      |
| Do sick leave because of back problems                  | 58.8                     |         | 54.2 |                             |   | NS      |
| Disability prior because of back problems               | 20.3                     |         | 22.2 |                             |   | NS      |
| Working part or full time                               | 20.9                     |         | 23.6 |                             |   | NS      |
| Uptake or compartment because of back problems          | 60.4                     |         | 64.6 |                             |   | NS      |
| Patient consider problems as back work injury           | 54.3                     | 12      | 64.2 | 5                           |   | NS      |